

Combatting Youth Vaping in Rural Kentucky: A Community-Based Educational Intervention

Background:

- Vaping poses serious health risks and often leads to other drug use. Rates are especially high in Kentucky, and studies have shown children vape more than adults. With high substance-use statistics in the Ephraim McDowell Community Health Needs Assessment, vaping is a clear concern for the Ephraim McDowell service area.

Research Statement and Purpose:

- Our goal is to lower the rate of vaping in youth within the Ephraim McDowell Service area by creating and providing an educational intervention for parents, teachers, youth, and community leaders on how to identify vaping, how to quit vaping, and why vaping is dangerous.

Methods:

- Through research of comprehensive reviews of vaping-associated health disparities within our community, we developed a feasible education intervention to share with the youth, parents, and community leaders in Ephraim's service area. Additionally, we partnered with the #iCANendthetrend campaign from Dr. Melinda Ickes at the University of Kentucky to develop teacher and resource officer intervention resources.

Results and Conclusion:

- With proven success of educational intervention we hope to disseminate our solution to lower current rates of youth vaping and more importantly prevent youth from initiating vape usage.

Keywords: Vaping, Youth, Education, Intervention